Woman 1: No, no, it can't be true! They can't do this to Joe. Not to my Joe.

(Woman 2 forces Woman 1 back into her seat.)

Woman 2:
There, there, don't upset yourself, dear. There's nothing to worry about.

(Woman 1 starts weeping and sobbing.)

Man 3: A bit big, wasn't it?

Man 4:
Nothing to what they used in the old days. I heard of a chap once the roots of whose teeth were wrapped round his jaw-bone. He was five hours in the chair.

Man 3:
None the worse for it, I'll bet.

(There is a sudden screech of metal from the surgery. Woman 1 gasps with horror and is about to make a dash for the surgery door when she is dragged back by Woman 2. Man 4 groans loudly. The Small Boy and the Little Girl at the table start a fight about a magazine they both want. Woman 8 and Woman 7 attempt to separate them. Through all this noise Woman 5 is still trying to show her photographs.)

Little Girl: It's mine! It's mine!

Small Boy:
No, it's mine! I saw it first.

Woman 7:
Sit down, Dorothea. Sit down and be quiet. I'll tell your daddy about this. Then there'll be trouble. Really, it's the last time I'll bring you anywhere.

Little Girl: See if I care.

Woman 6:
I wish some people would keep their children under control.

Woman 7: Well, really!

(At last the little girl and the small boy settle into their seats. They are both sulking.)

Man 2:
There should be a special waiting-room for children.

(The metallic screech is heard again from the surgery. Fresh sobs from Woman1.)



Woman 1:
I can't stand it. Oh, Joe! Joe! Joe!

(Man 4 groans.)

Small Boy:
What was that noise, Mummy?

Woman 8:
Don't ask awkward questions, Maurice.

Man 7:
I'll tell you, little boy. That noise was a man having a tooth out. That's how it's going to sound when you have yours out, only much, much louder, because then it'll be inside your head.

03-C-SR-The First Patient.indd 94 11-01-2019 15:39:04